# Pig Batch Profit Planner

Weaner to market: count every cost and every pig before you buy, so you know your real profit.

Fill in your own local prices. Figures in this guide come from the sources on the last page, not from us.

# Why plan the batch on paper?

**Cheap weaners can cost more.** A Canadian small-scale pig manual warns: "Purchasing a cheap pig will generally cost you more in the long run due to costs associated with disease, mortality, and slow growth."[1]

**Weaning weight follows the pig to market.** In an Australian trial of 720 pigs, pigs heavy at weaning (over 8.5 kg) weighed 101.3 kg at 123 days of age, versus 89.6 kg for light pigs (under 6.5 kg).[2]

**Losses decide profit.** A study of 121 sows on 12 intensive farms in Abuja, Nigeria, found 31% of piglets died before weaning; the top cause was the sow lying on piglets (31.34% of deaths).[3]

**Isolate new pigs.** FAO guidelines for smallholders advise keeping new pigs in a separate pen and watching them for disease for 14–30 days.[4]

# Step 1: Buying checklist

☐ Seller is known/trusted; I saw the farm or pen

☐ Weaners look alert, even-sized, no cough or diarrhoea

☐ I asked about vaccines, dewormers and other treatments[1]

☐ I weighed or estimated weight of each weaner

☐ Isolation pen ready before pigs arrive[4]

☐ Transport arranged; pigs not overcrowded

☐ Feed for the first 2 weeks already bought

# Step 2: Weaner record

| # | Date bought | Price | Weight (kg) | Sex | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | | | | | |
| 2 | | | | | |
| 3 | | | | | |
| 4 | | | | | |
| 5 | | | | | |
| 6 | | | | | |
| 7 | | | | | |
| 8 | | | | | |
| 9 | | | | | |
| 10 | | | | | |
| 11 | | | | | |
| 12 | | | | | |

# Step 3: Batch budget

| Cost item | Planned | Actual |
|---|---|---|
| Weaners (number × price) | | |
| Transport | | |
| Feed: starter | | |
| Feed: grower | | |
| Feed: finisher | | |
| Vaccines / dewormers / vet | | |
| Water, bedding, disinfectant | | |
| Labour | | |
| Housing repairs | | |
| Market transport and fees | | |
| Other | | |
| TOTAL COSTS (A) | | |

# Step 4: Income

| Line | Value |
|---|---|
| Pigs sold (number) | |
| Average price per pig | |
| Manure or other sales | |
| TOTAL INCOME (B) | |
| PROFIT = B – A | |
| Profit per pig = profit ÷ pigs sold | |

# Step 5: Weekly feed and weight log

| Week | Feed used (kg) | Feed cost | Avg weight (kg) | Deaths / sick |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | | | | |
| 2 | | | | |
| 3 | | | | |
| 4 | | | | |
| 5 | | | | |
| 6 | | | | |
| 7 | | | | |
| 8 | | | | |
| 9 | | | | |
| 10 | | | | |
| 11 | | | | |
| 12 | | | | |
| 13 | | | | |
| 14 | | | | |
| 15 | | | | |
| 16 | | | | |
| 17 | | | | |
| 18 | | | | |
| 19 | | | | |
| 20 | | | | |
| 21 | | | | |
| 22 | | | | |

Feed cost per kg gained = total feed cost ÷ (total market weight – total weaner weight).

# Step 6: Batch review

**How many pigs I started with, and how many I sold:**

**My biggest cost, and how to cut it next batch:**

**What caused losses, and the fix:**

**Will I run another batch? Same size, bigger or smaller?**

# Sources

1. Canadian Small-Scale Pig Farming Manual (2021), Government of New Brunswick, §1.3. https://www2.gnb.ca/content/dam/gnb/Departments/10/pdf/Agriculture/Livestock-Betail/canadian-small-scale-pig-farming-manual.pdf

2. Collins et al. (2017), Animal Nutrition 3(4). https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC5941277/

3. Reproductive performance of pigs raised by intensive management system in Abuja, Nigeria, Open Veterinary Journal (2019). https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC6460868/

4. FAO (2022), Guidelines for African swine fever prevention and control in smallholder pig farming in Asia, §3.1. https://openknowledge.fao.org/server/api/core/bitstreams/0115155a-86f8-43c9-a549-745707ea8a96/content

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